

THE AI PM PLAYBOOK

Building AI Products That Ship

A practitioner's playbook for founders, PMs, and builders turning AI ideas into products people actually use — from first prototype to first user.

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CHAPTER 1: The AI-Native PM Mindset

When building gets cheap, judgment gets expensive. The bottleneck has shifted from engineering capacity to decision quality.

"When building gets cheap, judgment gets expensive."

Learn to shift from writing backlog tickets to orchestrating systems of models, rules, code, data, and human trust using the Decision Quality Matrix.

CHAPTER 2: Mapping Model-Product Fit

Run the 'remove the AI' test. If the product isn't meaningfully worse, you've built a sticker. Master the 3-Tier AI Opportunity Model (AI-Only, AI-Better, AI-Optional) and the Build vs Buy vs Fine-Tune ladder.

CHAPTER 3: Vibe-Coding & Rapid Ideation

Build clickable prototypes in under 48 hours using the LoCuS Stack (Lovable, Cursor, Supabase). Test with 5 real users before writing production code.

CHAPTER 4: Demystifying AI Architecture

Tokens, context windows, vector embeddings, RAG retrieval, Model Context Protocol (MCP), and safe autonomous agent loops explained in plain English without math.

CHAPTER 5: Designing the AI Evaluation Harness

Why traditional QA fails for probabilistic AI. Build a 30-50 example Golden Dataset, define quality rubrics (groundedness, safety, tone), and set automated LLM-as-a-Judge ship gates.

CHAPTER 6: The AI Operations Stack

Manage cost, latency, and observability simultaneously. Build token budgets, deploy AI gateways, route prompts dynamically by difficulty, and log trace IDs.

CHAPTER 7: UX Design for Uncertainty

Guide users through non-deterministic software. Design for the 5 non-happy UX states (loading, empty, low-confidence, error, refused) and capture implicit data flywheels.

CHAPTER 8: AI Product Economics

Why flat seat pricing loses money on power users. Structure value-based pricing, hybrid credit limits, and scale flywheels that guarantee 80%+ gross margins.

EPILOGUE & APPENDIX: 30-Day Plan & One-Page AI Brief

A 4-week step-by-step roadmap to go from napkin idea to live telemetry, plus an 11-section fillable AI product brief doc.